

source software development. In response to a growing number of inquiries and interest on The Cryptography Mailing List, Satoshi wrote on November 17: “I’ll try and hurry up and release the source code as soon as possible to serve as a reference to help clear up all these implementation questions.”²⁵

Then Satoshi went quiet for a couple months as Wall Street continued to crumble. The Emergency Economic Stabilization Act of 2008 had done little to ameliorate the meltdown that ensued after Lehman’s bankruptcy. Passed by Congress and signed by President George W. Bush on October 3, the emergency act had established the \$700 billion TARP. As a result of TARP, the U.S. government acquired preferred stock in hundreds of banks as well as massive companies such as AIG, General Motors, and Chrysler. The stock didn’t come for free, though. It took \$550 billion in investments to stabilize those teetering mammoths.²⁶

In the opening moments of Bitcoin’s life as a public network, Satoshi made clear he was attuned to the failings of the global financial system. In the first instance of recording information on Bitcoin’s blockchain, Satoshi inscribed: “The Times 03/Jan/2009 Chancellor on brink of second bailout of banks,”²⁷ in reference to an article that appeared in the British publication *The Times* on the U.K.’s likely need to assist more banks in staying afloat.²⁸ Many years later people would realize that one of the most powerful use cases of blockchain technology was to inscribe immutable and transparent information that could never be wiped from the face of digital